

OUTING CLUB CONSTITUTION

Article I: Name

This organization shall be called the Rensselaer Outing Club, whose initials shall be "R.O.C."

Article II: Seal

The seal of the Rensselaer Outing Club shall be:



Article III: Mission Statement

The Rensselaer Outing Club's mission is to provide members of all skill levels the opportunity to go on wilderness trips, rent appropriate gear, and attend affordable leadership training and certifications to further their knowledge of the outdoors and outdoor adventure sports. We aim to promote respectful outdoor stewardship, LNT practices, safety, and enjoyment on all wilderness adventures.

Article IV: Purpose

The purpose of the Rensselaer Outing Club shall be:

- 1) To further outing activities among the club members at Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute by:
 - a) *organizing and conducting backpacking, winter mountaineering, whitewater kayaking, rafting, canoeing, cross country skiing, ice climbing, rock climbing,, horizontal and vertical caving, and other similar trips;*
 - b) *setting routes, holding climbing hours, and helping to maintain a bouldering wall on campus;*

- c) *creating interest in the principles of conservation of natural resources;*
- d) *providing opportunities for instructing its members in wilderness first aid, Leave No Trace principles, and forest fire prevention.*
- e) mirroring industry standards and best practices while being safe and having fun.

Article V: Affiliations

The Rensselaer Outing Club shall be a member of the following organizations:

- 1) Intercollegiate Outing Club Association (I.O.C.A.)
- 2) National Speleological Society (N.S.S.)
- 3) Rensselaer Student Union
- 4) Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (R.P.I.)

Article VI: Publication

The Cairn editor, who shall be elected in accordance with Article X of this constitution, shall be responsible for the R.O.C. newsletter entitled The Cairn. The purpose of The Cairn shall be:

- 1) To inform all interested parties of the activities of the R.O.C.
- 2) To discuss any matters that the Cairn Editor deems of interest.

Article VII: Membership

Membership in the Rensselaer Outing Club shall be governed by the following rules and regulations:

- 1) Membership in the Rensselaer Outing Club shall be open to all undergraduate students, graduate students, faculty members, and employees of Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute.
- 2) An applicant for membership shall fill out a membership form provided by the Rensselaer Outing Club. uch forms when properly filled out shall be approved by a club officer. Upon payment of dues, the applicant shall be considered a member of the Rensselaer Outing Club.

- 3) The dues of the organization will be determined by the Executive Committee when they budget for the following year in accordance with Union policies.
- 4) Renewal of membership shall be automatic upon payment of current dues.
- 5) To obtain the status of a patch member and to gain the privilege of wearing a R.O.C. patch, a member must participate in three official R.O.C. trips in three different activities including at least one overnight trip, participate in 3 hours of club service, write for The Cairn, and obtain approval from the Executive Committee. The Executive Committee shall determine what constitutes an official club trip.
- 6) To become an honorary member, a person shall have distinguished themselves by exemplary service to the club or to the outdoors, and shall have the unanimous approval of the Executive Committee.
- 7) A voting member shall be a patched undergraduate member or a patched graduate member. Faculty shall not be voting members.
- 8) It is the policy of R.O.C to provide, to the maximum extent feasible, equal opportunity to all qualified individuals without regard to race, ethnicity, color, religion, national origin, gender, sexual orientation, or disability for all aspects of the Club's activities.
- 9) Hazing, reckless or intentional endangerment to health, or forced consumption of alcohol or other drugs for the purpose of initiation into or continuing membership of R.O.C. is strictly prohibited.

Article VIII: Executive Committee

The Executive Committee of the club shall consist of the club's president, vice president, treasurer, secretary, Cairn editor, Pit chair, and the member at large. They shall be elected annually in the manner in Article X of this constitution for a term commencing at the close of the annual election meeting and ending at the close of the annual election meeting of the following year. If a member of the Executive Committee ceases to be a student at R.P.I. or is ruled, by R.P.I., to be ineligible to hold office, their position shall be considered vacant. If an Executive Committee member must leave for ARCH, their position shall be considered vacant.

Meetings of the Executive Committee may be called by the president, a majority of the Executive Committee, or a petition signed by 25% of the voting members of the club. Every member of the Executive Committee must be informed, in advance, of every Executive Committee meeting. All business of the Executive Committee shall be transacted at Executive Committee meetings. All motions (except those for honorary membership) must receive the votes of the majority of the entire Executive Committee to be passed. Results of

Executive Committee meetings shall be distributed to all members of the club.

Article IX: Administration

The general administration of the club shall be vested in the Executive Committee consisting of the officers and members enumerated in Article VIII of this constitution. The duties of the Executive committee which may be delegated to one or more committees, chairmen, trip leaders, other members of the club, or the entire voting membership, shall include the following;

- 1) To supervise all club activities.
- 2) To be responsible for all club finances.
- 3) To plan and schedule club trips.
- 4) To give leadership to members.
- 5) To designate trips for patch membership qualification.
- 6) To approve honorary membership.
- 7) To make decisions on disciplinary problems concerning club affairs, having the power to take appropriate action thereon.
- 8) To fix the date of the annual election meeting, which must occur before the end of the Spring semester preceding the previous annual election meeting.
- 9) All duties enumerated elsewhere in this constitution.
- 10) The club as a whole can veto any action the Executive Committee takes by means of a petition signed by 60% of the voting membership of the club.

Article X: Elections

The election of members of the Executive Committee shall be governed by the following rules:

- 1) Election of members of the Executive Committee shall take place at the annual election meeting. At this election, members of the Executive Committee shall be elected for one year
- 2) The patch members shall nominate at least one candidate for each position on the Executive Committee.
- 3) All members of the club shall be notified of the date of the election meeting and the nominations for the Executive Committee at least 14 days before the meeting or

sooner under extenuating circumstances.

- 4) All candidates for membership on the Executive Committee shall be voting members of the club and eligible to hold such office under the regulations of R.P.I.. Additionally, all candidates must be enrolled R.P.I. students the semester following the election.
- 5) Vacancies occurring in the Executive Committee shall be filled at a special election meeting by the same procedure used to elect the members of the Executive Committee at the annual election meeting. The elected member shall serve only the remainder of the vacant position's term.
- 6) Each voting member shall have one vote. The order of election of the Executive Committee officers shall be as follows: President, Vice President, Treasurer, Pit Chair, Secretary, Cairn Editor, Member at Large.
- 7) If any member suspects that the Election Meeting is not conducted fairly or is conducted with intent to deceive the membership the member should notify the Rensselaer Union Executive Board.

Article XI: Meetings

The club shall hold meetings every week unless otherwise specified by the Executive Committee. The club shall hold an annual meeting for the election of the Executive Committee each spring. The annual election meeting shall be held at a date and place set by the Executive Committee. Special meetings may be called by the Executive Committee, by a petition of 25% of the voting members or by the club's president.

Article XII: Rules of Conduct

The following rules of conduct shall be in effect at all times:

- 1) Adhere to the Rensselaer Handbook of Student Rights and Responsibilities and Rensselaer Union Guidelines & Procedures
- 2) Intoxicating beverages, illegal substances, and firearms shall be prohibited on all club activities and trips.
- 3) The privilege of using privately owned land shall not be abused.
- 4) On all trips particular care shall be given to follow Leave No Trace principles.
- 5) On state and federal land, all rules and regulations shall be observed and strictly adhered to. Offenders shall be held personally responsible, rather than the club or its officers.
- 6) The SARP(s) shall have final authority on any matter pertaining to the safety or

general welfare of any participants, trip/ assistant trip leaders, and R.P.I.-owned equipment/property in a club activity.

- 7) Trip leaders shall have final authority on all matters on their trips except as specified in section 5 and 6 of this article.
- 8) Members may be assessed if they fail to show up for a trip or cancel their reservations if the club has made commitments involving an expense as a result of their reservations. Advance deposits may not be refunded under the same circumstances.
- 9) All club members must fill out health and risk forms truthfully and fully.

Article XIII: Officers of the Executive Committee

The officers of the club shall perform such functions as usually pertain to the offices held by them. The remaining member at large shall perform such duties as may be assigned to them by the president. The functions of the officers are described below.

President

The President is to oversee all aspects of the club, run the weekly meetings, and act as the point of contact for outside club members and organizations.

Vice President

The Vice President is to stand in as acting President in the President's absence, organize all club advertising efforts (including apparel ordering), and edit the advertising budget for the club.

Treasurer

The Treasurer is to take in dues and validate club members, organize with the activity chairs and turn in a club budget every year, and is in charge of the club finances.

Pit Chair

The Pit Chair is to work with Outdoor Programs to assist in: maintaining all of the gear in the Gear Room (along with activity chairs) and to hold weekly hours in which club members can rent out gear.

The Pit Chair is to represent the Outing Club on all topics concerning gear rentals, Gear Room projects and organization, and gear acquisition with R.P.I..

Secretary

The Secretary is to take minutes at all meetings, maintain the club mailing list, and send out meeting minutes to the club members.

The Secretary is to inform club members of all business at general body meetings and any decisions made by or under consideration by the Executive Committee. This information should be conveyed through the club mailing list. This list will be maintained by the Secretary.

Cairn Editor

The Cairn Editor is to update and maintain the website, outing.org, and to publish the club's newsletter, The Cairn.

Member at Large

The Member at Large is to plan the Fall Formal event, plan the Spring Banquet, and help with anything needed of them.

Article XIV: Quorum

The quorum for the transaction of business at the annual election meeting or any other meeting of the club shall be 40% of the voting membership.

Article XV: Removal of Members of the Executive Committee and Expulsion of Members

At any meeting of the club, a motion to remove a member of the Executive Committee from their position for failure to carry out their duties in the best interest of the club, or for any actions detrimental to the club, can be brought up by a petition of 25% of the total voting membership of the club. A full discussion of the charges shall be held at that meeting, or at the next meeting of the club if the member is not present at the meeting when the petition is presented. If within 14 days of the discussion, 2/3 of the voting members demand, by petition, that the member of the Executive Committee be removed, this member is stripped from all duties and responsibilities, and their position becomes vacant.

A member of the club may be expelled for actions detrimental to the club by the same

procedure as for removing a member of the Executive Committee.

Any member may appeal their removal by petitioning the Judicial Board of the Rensselaer Union and any other member may appeal their removal by petitioning the Executive Board. The removal remains in effect until reversed.

Article XVI: Amendments

This constitution may be amended by either of the following methods.

- 1) A proposed amendment shall be approved at a meeting of the Executive Committee by a majority of its members. The Executive Committee shall set a date for a meeting of the club to take action on the amendment. This date shall be within 14 days of the Executive Committee meeting and all voting members shall be given at least 7 days notice of the meeting and its purpose. If at such a meeting 2/3 of the entire voting membership of the club approve the amendment, it shall be considered passed. Voting may be done in person or by written proxy.
- 2) A proposed amendment shall be submitted to the Executive Committee in a petition signed by 25% of the voting membership of the club. The Executive Committee shall then set a date for a meeting of the club to take action on the amendment. This date shall be within 14 days of the submission of the petition and all voting members shall be given at least 7 days notice of this meeting and its purpose. If at such a meeting 2/3 of the entire voting membership of the club approve the amendment, it shall be considered passed. Voting may be done in person or by written proxy.

Article XVII: Summer ARCH Liaisons

Summer ARCH liaison positions are voted by the newly elected spring ECOMM members. The sole responsibility of liaison positions is to upkeep the club in the summer. Liaison positions can only function in the club as described in their descriptions below.

Meetings Liaison

The Meetings Liaison is to organize and run meetings weekly unless otherwise specified by the liaisons.

Pit Liaison

The Pit Liaison is to be the main student contact for the Gear Room and to operate under the Pit Chair.

Activities Liaison

The Activities Liaison is to plan summer events.

Article XVIII: Wall Chair

The Wall Chair is to work with Outdoor Programs to assist in maintaining and organizing the rock wall and providing a sufficient number of climbing hours in which club members can climb.

The Wall Chair is to represent the Outing Club on all topics concerning rock wall maintenance, organization, operation, and events with R.P.I..

Wall Chair is to be elected under the same process as Executive Committee elections immediately following Executive Committee elections during the annual election meeting. The Wall Chair is not a part of the Executive Committee. However when matters involving the Wall are being discussed by the Executive Committee the Wall Chair shall be included and have a say in said discussions.

Article XIX: Conflict

In case of conflict between this constitution and any rules or regulations of Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute or of the Student Union, the rules or regulations of R.P.I. or of the Student Union shall supersede this constitution and shall be binding upon this club.

Article XX: Abrogation

This Constitution, upon its adoption, shall abrogate any previous governing documents relating to the Club. This shall not be construed as to deny any office or position to anyone serving out a term elected under a previous constitution.

Amendments

18 March. 1958 - Article VIII. Board of Directors

The business of the club shall be managed by a Board of Directors consisting of not less than three nor more than ten members, all of whom shall be over twenty-one years of age and at least one of whom shall be a citizen of the United States and a resident of New York State, and who need not be members of the Rensselaer Outing Club, Inc. The number of members of the Board of Directors will be determined between three and ten by the voting membership of the Rensselaer Outing Club, Inc. Such Directors shall hold office until their successors are elected.

Each annual budget of the Rensselaer Outing Club, Inc. shall be submitted to the Board of Directors for approval, before its submission to the Rensselaer Student Union.

2 May, 1961 – Article IV. Clause 3

The dues of the club shall be \$2.00 for the year, payable at the beginning of the year, or in the case of second semester applicants, \$1.00. There will also be a \$1.00 initial fee for new members.

21 March, 1972 – Article VII, Paragraph 1, Sentence 1

The Executive Committee of the club shall consist of the club president, vice president, treasurer, secretary, Pit chairman, Cairn editor, and one member at large.

21 March, 1972 – Article X Clause 7

The order of election of the Executive Committee officers shall be as follows: president, vice president, treasurer, secretary, Pit chairman, Cairn editor, member at large.

1 July, 2014 – Article I

Rensselaer Outing Club is no longer a corporation and is thus known as Rensselaer Outing Club instead of Rensselaer Outing Club, Inc.

1 July, 2014 – Article II

An electronic version of the seal has been added.

1 July, 2014 – Article III

Changed cycling to mountain biking and skiing to backcountry skiing. Added whitewater rafting, kayaking, and ice climbing

1 July, 2014 – Article IV

Added the club's National Speleological Society and Student Union affiliations.

1 July, 2014 – Article VI

Updated membership fees and process for becoming a member as well as the process for becoming a patch member.

1 July, 2014 – Article VII

Updated the text for the members of the Executive Committee, better defined election timing. Rephrased distribution of meeting happenings to not be media specific.

1 July, 2014 – Article VIII (board of directors)

Removed everything about the board of directors. As the club is no longer a corporation, this is no longer necessary.

1 July, 2014 – Article VIII (administration)

Removed "To insure proper chaperonage of overnight co-ed outings."

1 July, 2014 – Article IX

Removed election procedure for Board of Directors.

1 July, 2014 – Article XIV

To be more explicit, added that in the case of removal/expulsion, the officer position becomes vacant.

11 November, 2015 - Article III

Added a Mission Statement to the constitution.

11 November, 2015 - Article XII

Added descriptions for all of the officer positions.

11 November, 2015 - Article V

Added College Outside as an affiliation.

6 September, 2019 - Article III

Mission statement updated.

5 February, 2025 - Article IV

Updated purpose to accurately reflect the sports that the club participates in.

5 February, 2025 - Article IV

Added maintaining a bouldering wall as a purpose of the club.

5 February, 2025 - Article VII

Updated membership to accurately reflect that dues are determined through the budgeting process and that alumni cannot be members of the club.

5 February, 2025 - Article VII

Updated the Patch membership requirements to accurately reflect the number of service hours necessary and the requirement to write for The Cairn.

5 February, 2025 - Article VII

Added an equal opportunity statement to Article VII and removed gender specific language.

5 February, 2025 - Article VII

Added a statement to specifically prohibit hazing.

5 February, 2025 - Article VIII

Updated Executive Committee policy to reflect the process when officers must leave their position vacant due to Arch.

5 February, 2025 - Article IX

Updated wording to be more clear.

5 February, 2025 - Article X

Clarified that the Executive Committee Positions are elected for a full year. Also specified that candidates must be R.P.I. students for the following semester. Also specified that special elections fill a position for the remainder of the position's term.

5 February, 2025 - Article X

Updated election procedure to include the order of elections and a process in case of an unfair election.

5 February, 2025 - Article XII

Updated the wording of Rules of Conduct to be more clear.

5 February, 2025 - Article XIII

Added interfacing with Outdoor Programs on topics concerning gear as a function of the Pit Chair. Removed organizing Fall Lake George as a function of the Vice President and the Member at Large. Added organizing Fall Formal as a function of the Member at Large.

5 February, 2025 - Article XIII

Adds informing the club members of the decisions of the Executive Committee to the Secretary's duties.

5 February, 2025 - Article XV

Added a process for a member to appeal their removal from the club.

5 February, 2025 - Article XVIII

Added a section defining summer ARCH positions.

5 February, 2025 - Article XVIII

Changes wall chair to being a patch elected position rather than Ecomm elected.

26 March, 2025

Changes made to reflect requirements from R.P.I. Risk Management.